

COLORFIELD

by Mark Steere

INTRODUCTION

Colorfield is played on an even sided, square grid of dots. **Figure 1** shows a 6x6 grid. The dots outline an odd number of unit sized squares. In this case, 25 squares. Two players, Red and Blue, take turns drawing unit length **line segments of their own color**, one segment per turn, starting with Red. Passing is not allowed, but if you don't have an available move, your turn is skipped. Mark Steere designed Colorfield in August 2026.

Figure 1
6x6 grid

PLAY

On your turn, draw a segment connecting two orthogonally adjacent dots. If a loop is formed, the surrounded region is owned by whoever has more segments in the surrounding loop. The region is then colored in the owner's color. **Figure 2** shows colored, surrounded regions. The red region is surrounded by 5 red segments and 3 blue segments. The blue region is surrounded by 2 red segments and 4 blue segments.

LEGAL MOVES

You must not form a loop comprised of an equal number of red and blue segments. In **Figure 3**, Red must not draw a segment on the black, dotted line. This would form a loop with 5 red segments and 5 blue segments - an equal number.

Once a loop is formed, **the surrounded region cannot then be subdivided.** In **Figure 4**, Red must not draw a segment on the black, dotted line. This would subdivide a surrounded region.

OBJECT OF THE GAME

When the entire grid has been partitioned into loop-surrounded regions, whoever owns the most territory wins. In **Figure 5**, Red has won with 16 squares against Blue's 9 squares.

DESIGN NOTES

I wanted a dot connection and enclosure game with two colors of line segments. Not just one color.

AUTHOR'S NOTE

Feel free to publish this rule sheet and to program the game of Colorfield. No licensing fee or royalties are expected. However, please don't change the name or the rules, and please attribute the game to me, Mark Steere. My other games can be found at marksteeregames.com.

Figure 2
Surrounded regions

Figure 3
Illegal Red move

Figure 4
Illegal Red move

Figure 5
Red has won